Jingyi Liu

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EDUCATION

Purdue University, Mitch Daniels School of Business *West Lafayette, IN*

- Ph.D. in Economics (GPA: 3.87/4.0) *2021-May 2027 (exp.)*

  Committees: Timothy N. Bond (Chair), Joshua Chan, Victoria Prowse, Kevin Mumford

The University of Chicago *Chicago, IL*

- Master of Arts in Public Policy with Certificate in Research Methods *2019-2020*

University of International Business and Economics *Beijing, China*

- Bachelor of Arts in Business Translation *2015-2019*
- Bachelor of Economics in Finance (Double major)

RESEARCH INTERESTS

- **Fields**: Labor Economics, Economic History, Applied Bayesian Econometrics
- **Topics**: Racial Inequality, Gender Inequality

WORKING PAPERS

[1] **Quantifying the Role of Social Connectedness: Evidence from the Great Migration**

Abstract: This paper explores how hometown-based social networks helped Black migrants translate emerging opportunities into economic gains in the 1940s. Wartime economic mobility and postwar boom expanded opportunities for Black Americans, but who was able to take advantage of them? I estimate the causal effects of hometown-based social networks on occupational upgrading of Black Southern migrants who moved to the North between 1940 and 1950. I develop a novel Bartik-style instrument that exploits the exogenous variation in migrants' destination choices and thereby generates variation in their predicted exposure to historical social networks established by earlier migrants at Northern destinations. I find that hometown-based social networks shifted both male and female migrants away from lower-skilled and lower-paying occupations and increased their representation in skilled occupations by 1950. Due to substantial gender-based occupational segregation, the trajectory of occupational upgrading differed considerably by gender. For both male and female migrants, the positive effect of hometown-based social networks on skilled employment was concentrated in industries with a relatively high representation of workers of the same gender. This paper offers a new approach to address the endogeneity concern in network economics, and highlights the importance of social networks in connecting low-skilled and socially disadvantaged groups with high-quality employment opportunities.

[2] **Understanding Prejudice: Competition and the Evolution of Racial Attitudes in the Mid-20th Century**

with Timothy N. Bond

Abstract: We estimate the causal effect of the Great Migration on racial prejudice. We overcome standard limitations of survey-based measures of prejudice by developing a new Bayesian method to estimate prejudice as a latent variable. Our approach can identify sub-group rates of prejudice across time on a consistent scale using different survey items, so long as there is always at least one item that overlaps in any period. We find consistent evidence that the Great Migration increased prejudice among Whites who would have

faced the most labor market competition from these migrants. White high school dropouts, Whites in urban areas, and Whites in blue collar occupations all became more prejudiced in states that were more exposed to the Great Migration. In contrast, we find little evidence of increased prejudice among college-educated or white-collar Whites. By identifying the effects of the Great Migration across demographic groups who would have had different forms of contact with newly arriving Black Americans, we highlight how the Great Migration polarized American values.

[3] **The Legacy of Redlining and Inequality in the Provision of Public Amenities**
with Sisi Zhou

Abstract: We estimate the causal effect of redlining, a New Deal policy, on access to public amenities among current Black and White city residents. We consider two modes of travel: walking and driving. For each mode, we measure accessibility to public amenities using a gravity-based measure with a negative exponential distance-decay function, calculated separately for Black and White residents. Using a regression discontinuity design, we find that redlining had long-term negative effects on residents' access to public amenities within walking distance, affecting both Black and White residents. In contrast, when driving is considered, redlining increased access to public amenities, with particularly large gains for White residents. We attribute these findings to local investment distortions arising from the urban hierarchy encoded in HOLC redlining maps. Public amenities were disproportionately concentrated in predominantly White neighborhoods, which account for a relatively small share of the city's population, placing these amenities beyond walking distance for many Black and White residents. Our findings highlight how a racially discriminatory policy can harm the interests of residents across racial groups.

[4] **A New Measure of Gender Bias in the United States, 1940-2000**

Abstract: This paper introduces the first comprehensive measure of gender bias spanning 1940–2000. Using historical Gallup public opinion surveys, I identify underlying gender attitudes from binary responses to survey questions using a Bayesian latent factor model. This approach enables a consistent measure of gender bias over six decades despite changes in survey items. This new measure of gender bias provides an unprecedented opportunity for economists and social scientists to examine the evolution of gender attitudes in the United States over the second half of the twentieth century.

WORK IN PROGRESS

[1] Racial Prejudice and Black Representation in Analytical Occupations

[2] Replacing Kinship with Community? Social Networks and Black Families during the Great Migration

DATA PRODUCTS

[1] **Racial Prejudice Index, 1940-1970**
State-level estimates of racial prejudice for 48 U.S. states over 1940-1970, by census year and across demographic groups

[2] **Gender Bias Index, 1940-2000**
State-level estimates of gender bias for 48 U.S. states over 1940-2000, by census year and across demographic groups

AWARDS & FELLOWSHIPS

- Fredrick N. Andrews Fellowship *2021-2026*
- Daniels School of Business Certificate for Outstanding Teaching *2024*
- Papke Graduate Award for the Study of Public Sector Economics *2024-2025*
- Richard Sutch Student Travel Award *2026*

CONFERENCES

- Data-Intensive Research Conference *July 2026*
- Social Science History Annual Conference *Nov 2026*

WORKING EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant for Professor Robert Kaestner, The University of Chicago *2020-2021*

- Developed research proposals and participated in administrative data application
- Collected, cleaned, and analyzed data to produce initial findings by figures and regressions

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor, Purdue University

- ECON 251 Microeconomics *2024*

Teaching Assistant, Purdue University

- ECON 485 Race and Gender Discrimination in the Labor Market *2023-2026*
- ECON 632 Labor Economics *2022-2025*
- ECON 674 Microeconometrics *2021-2023*

REFERENCES

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